

# Part 1 - User Thinkaloud:

## Good Practices:

1. Guiding the User Through a Familiar Task (Opening Mail and Weather Apps):

- **What the interviewer did:** The interviewer guided the user to independently open the Mail and Weather apps, using straightforward instructions.
- **Effect on the think-aloud process:** The user felt confident and engaged with the task, successfully verbalizing their thought process.
- **Why this was beneficial:** It ensured the task was easy to understand, helping the user focus on explaining their actions rather than being confused about the task itself.

2. Teaching the User to Use the Start Key to Navigate Back:

- **What the interviewer did:** The interviewer showed the user how to press the Start key to return to the home screen.
- **Effect on the think-aloud process:** The user became more comfortable navigating, reducing frustration and providing clearer feedback about their experience.
- **Why this was beneficial:** It improved the user's confidence, helping them complete tasks efficiently and making their feedback more relevant and insightful.

## Bad Practices:

1. Failing to Provide Clear Hints (Closing the Mail App):

- **What the interviewer did:** The interviewer expected the user to close the Mail app without giving clear instructions, dismissing the user's confusion by saying, "A regular person should know this."
- **Effect on the think-aloud process:** The user became frustrated, reducing their willingness to continue speaking aloud.
- **What could have been done differently:** The interviewer could have offered constructive hints or clarified the expected action,

helping the user feel more supported and willing to share their thoughts.

2. Providing Vague Instructions for Saving a Document:

- **What the interviewer did:** The interviewer asked the user to save a document but didn't specify its source or context.
- **Effect on the think-aloud process:** The user was confused about the task, leading to fragmented or incomplete feedback.
- **What could have been done differently:** The interviewer should have clearly described the task's context, ensuring the user understood what they were being asked to do.

3. Giving Unclear Guidance on Opening the Internet Browser:

- **What the interviewer did:** The interviewer instructed the user to open a browser without specifying where to find it.
- **Effect on the think-aloud process:** The user struggled to locate the browser, leading to frustration and reduced focus on verbalizing their thought process.
- **What could have been done differently:** The interviewer could have directed the user to look in specific locations, such as the taskbar or start menu, keeping the process smoother.

4. Providing Ambiguous Instructions for Searching Online:

- **What the interviewer did:** The interviewer vaguely told the user to "search on the internet," without explaining how or using specific examples.
- **Effect on the think-aloud process:** The user was left unsure of how to proceed, which interrupted their flow and limited the insights they could share.
- **What could have been done differently:** The interviewer could have provided a specific search query or demonstrated the search bar's location to better guide the user.

## Part 2 - Usability Aspect Reports:

### Positive Aspects:

1. Straightforward Navigation for Common Apps:
  - **What worked well:** Users could easily access commonly used apps like Mail and Weather due to intuitive and clearly labeled icons.
  - **Effect:** This allowed users to quickly complete tasks with minimal effort, boosting overall satisfaction and confidence.
2. Logical Placement of the Start Key:
  - **What worked well:** The Start key was prominently positioned, making it easy for users to return to the home screen.
  - **Effect:** Users felt in control of their navigation, which minimized confusion and improved their ability to reset when lost.

### Challenging Aspects:

1. Ambiguous App Exit Mechanism:
  - **What could be improved:** Users were unsure how to close apps, with no dedicated close button or indication of how to exit.
  - **Effect:** This caused confusion and unnecessary delays, negatively impacting the overall experience.
  - **Recommendation:** Add a visible “Close” button or swipe gesture to exit apps, making the process more intuitive.
2. Confusing Document Saving Workflow:
  - **What could be improved:** The process for saving a document was unclear, with no visible guidance or prompts.
  - **Effect:** Users struggled to complete this task, leading to frustration and lower task completion rates.
  - **Recommendation:** Implement a guided workflow or tooltips for saving documents to clarify the steps.

### 3. Difficulty Locating the Internet Browser:

- **What could be improved:** The browser's location wasn't obvious to users, with no shortcut or indication of where it was stored.
- **Effect:** Users wasted time searching for the browser, reducing efficiency and increasing frustration.
- **Recommendation:** Add a visible browser icon on the home screen or taskbar for easier access.

### 4. Lack of Search Guidance Within the Browser:

- **What could be improved:** The interface didn't provide clear instructions or placeholders for searching within the browser.
- **Effect:** Users hesitated and made errors when attempting to perform a search, limiting the browser's usability.
- **Recommendation:** Include a placeholder text in the search bar, such as "Type your search here," to guide users.

| No. UE-01                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       | Problem/Good Aspect |
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| <b>Name:</b> Confusing Document Saving Workflow                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                     |
| <b>Evidence:</b> <p>During the user evaluation, participants struggled to save a document. They were unclear on where the document was located or how to proceed with saving it. No visual guidance or instructions were provided in the interface.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                     |
| <b>Explanation:</b> <p>The interface lacked any visible or intuitive prompts for saving a document, such as labels, tooltips, or steps guiding users through the process. This caused confusion and reduced the likelihood of task completion. This violates the heuristic of User Control and Freedom because users could not easily recover from their confusion or proceed effectively.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                     |
| <b>Severity or Benefit:</b> <p><b>Rating:</b> 3 (Major usability problem)</p> <p><b>Justification (Frequency, Impact, Persistence, Weights):</b></p> <p><b>Frequency:</b> This issue is likely to be encountered frequently by new or casual users who need to save documents, as the process lacks clarity.</p> <p><b>Impact:</b> High impact, as users are unable to complete an essential task and may waste considerable time searching for solutions.</p> <p><b>Persistence:</b> Persistent, as users will encounter the same problem each time they attempt to save a document until a clear solution is implemented.</p> |                     |
| <b>Possible solution and/or trade-offs:</b> <p><b>Solution:</b> Add a guided workflow with step-by-step instructions, such as a pop-up prompt or tooltip when users attempt to save. Include visual indicators like a highlighted "Save" button or labeled options for saving locations.</p> <p><b>Trade-offs:</b> Adding these features might slightly increase visual clutter, but this can be minimized with well-designed UI elements.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                  |                     |
| <b>Relationships:</b> <p>Related to UE-02 (Unclear Guidance for Searching Online) due to the shared need for more explicit interface guidance.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                     |

| No.UE-02                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Problem/Good Aspect |
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| <b>Name: Unclear Guidance on Searching in the Browser</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |                     |
| <b>Evidence:</b><br><br>Users were instructed to “search on the internet” but were not given specific directions on how to locate or use the search bar within the browser. Many users hesitated or clicked random areas, indicating confusion.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |                     |
| <b>Explanation:</b><br><br>The interface provided no visual cues or instructions to guide users toward the search bar, violating the heuristic of Visibility of System Status and Help and Documentation. Users were left guessing how to interact with the browser.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                     |
| <b>Severity or Benefit:</b><br><i>Rating:</i> 2 (Minor usability problem)<br><b>Justification (Frequency, Impact, Persistence, Weights):</b><br><b>Frequency:</b> Common for users unfamiliar with the browser or its layout, especially for new or infrequent users.<br><b>Impact:</b> Moderate impact, as users eventually found the search bar but wasted time and felt frustrated.<br><b>Persistence:</b> Persistent, as users will encounter the same issue each time they use the browser until they become familiar with it. |                     |
| <b>Possible solution and/or Trade-offs:</b><br><br><b>Solution:</b> Add placeholder text in the search bar, such as “Type your search here,” and highlight the search bar when the browser opens for the first time.<br><b>Trade-offs:</b> Minimal trade-offs, as the added text and highlight would only enhance the user's initial interaction without detracting from the interface's simplicity.                                                                                                                                |                     |
| <b>Relationships:</b><br><br>Related to UE-01 (Confusing Document Saving Workflow) due to the shared issue of unclear guidance in essential tasks.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                     |